

Unit 5: Preparing and Presenting Research Report

5.1 Layout of the Research Report

A **research report** is a formal document that presents the findings, analysis, and conclusions of a study in a systematic way. A clear layout helps readers understand the study easily.

Typical layout includes:

1. **Title Page** – Contains the report title, researcher's name, institution, date, and supervisor's name.
2. **Declaration & Acknowledgment** – Researcher's statement of originality and gratitude to contributors.
3. **Abstract/Executive Summary** – Brief overview (150–250 words) summarizing objectives, methods, findings, and conclusions.
4. **Table of Contents** – Lists chapters, sections, and page numbers.
5. **List of Tables/Figures** – If applicable.
6. **Main Body of Report** – Introduction, Literature Review, Methodology, Results, Discussion, Conclusion, and Recommendations.
7. **References/Bibliography** – All sources cited in the text (APA 7th edition style).
8. **Appendices** – Additional data, questionnaires, or charts not included in the main text.

5.2 Structure of a Project Report

A well-structured project report typically includes the following **five major sections**:

1. Introduction

- Presents the research background, problem statement, objectives, and scope.
- Explains the rationale or significance of the study.
- Ends with a clear outline of the report structure.

2. Literature Review

- Critically reviews previous studies related to the topic.
- Identifies research gaps and theoretical perspectives.
- Provides the foundation for the current research framework.

3. Methodology

- Describes how the research was conducted.
- Includes research design, sampling methods, data collection tools, and analysis techniques.

- Ensures **replicability and transparency**.

4. Results

- Presents analyzed data using tables, charts, and graphs.
- Focuses on **objective findings** without interpretation.

5. Discussion

- Interprets results in relation to hypotheses and literature.
- Explains implications, limitations, and suggestions for future research.

5.3 Referencing and Citations (APA 7th Edition)

Proper referencing prevents plagiarism and gives credit to original authors.

The **APA (American Psychological Association) 7th Edition** is one of the most widely used citation styles.

Key points:

- **In-text citation (Author-Date style):**
 - Example: *(Kothari, 2004)* or *Creswell (2018) explains that...*
- **Reference List Entry:**
 - Books → Author, A. A. (Year). *Title of the book*. Publisher.
 - Example: Kothari, C. R. (2004). *Research Methodology: Methods and Techniques*. New Age International.
 - Journal Article → Author, A. A., & Author, B. B. (Year). Title of the article. *Title of the Journal*, volume(issue), page–page. <https://doi.org/...>
 - Website → Author, A. A. (Year, Month Day). Title of the webpage. *Website Name*. URL

5.4 Finalizing the Research Report

Finalizing a research report involves ensuring that the document is **clear, accurate, and professional** before submission or presentation.

Steps include:

1. **Proofreading and Editing:**
 - Check grammar, spelling, punctuation, and formatting.
 - Ensure consistency in headings, font, spacing, and references.
2. **Formatting:**
 - Follow institutional guidelines (margin size, font type, citation format).

3. Plagiarism Check:

- Use plagiarism-detection tools (e.g., Turnitin, Grammarly) to confirm originality.

4. Final Review:

- Verify that objectives, methods, and results are logically aligned.

5. Presentation:

- Prepare slides (PowerPoint or poster) summarizing key findings for oral defense.